

DISCOVERY PHASE

Empathy Map & Stakeholder Experience

Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow

Date	02-10-2026	Project Phase	Stakeholder & User Discovery
Platform	ServiceNow	Version	1.0

1. Purpose of the Empathy Map

The empathy map captures the needs, expectations, concerns, and experience of the people involved in the Automated Network Request Management process. It is used to understand the human side of the workflow before finalizing ServiceNow configuration and automation.

The stakeholder set for this project consists of End Users (Requesters), IT Admins, the Network Fulfilment Team, and Approvers.

2. Stakeholder Landscape

Stakeholder	Role	Needs / Expectations	Impact of Automation
End Users (Requesters)	Employees or teams requesting network services through Service Portal only	Simple, intuitive request submission Fast turnaround Status visibility	Faster request fulfilment Better visibility through ServiceNow portal
IT Admins	Manage ServiceNow configurations, integrations, and workflows.	Reliable automation Minimal manual intervention Easy change management	Reduced ticket workload Easier maintenance and updates
Network Fulfilment Team	Executes network changes and ensures infrastructure reliability.	Clear, complete request data Fewer manual tasks Standardized processes	Automated task generation Reduced human error More time for complex issues
Approvers	Managers or compliance officers approving requests.	Policy enforcement Quick, informed approval workflows	Structured, automated approval routing Better audit trails

3. Empathy Map — End Users (Requesters)

Perspective: Employees or teams requesting network services through the Service Portal only.

SAYS "I need to submit the request quickly." "Where is my request now?"	THINKS "Have I provided everything required?" "Who is handling my request?"	DOES Submits a network request through the Service Portal. Checks request status and waits for fulfilment.
FEELS Wants a simple process, fast turnaround, and confidence that the request is progressing.	PAINS Complex or unclear request submission. Limited status visibility. Waiting for fulfilment.	GAINS Simple guided submission. Faster fulfilment. Clear visibility through ServiceNow.

4. Empathy Map — IT Admins

Perspective: Team members responsible for ServiceNow configuration, integrations, and workflows.

SAYS "The workflow should be reliable." "Changes should be easy to maintain."	THINKS "Can this automation be supported without excessive manual intervention?" "Are configuration changes controlled?"	DOES Manages ServiceNow configuration, workflows, integrations, and updates.
FEELS Wants predictable automation and manageable change processes.	PAINS Manual ticket workload. Maintenance effort. Complex or fragile automation.	GAINS Reduced ticket workload. Reliable automation. Easier maintenance and updates.

5. Empathy Map — Network Fulfilment Team

Perspective: Team members who execute network changes and ensure infrastructure reliability.

SAYS "Give me complete request information." "I need clear fulfilment tasks."	THINKS "Is the request complete and properly approved?" "Do I have everything needed to fulfil it?"	DOES Reviews network requests, performs fulfilment activities, and updates task/request status.
FEELS Wants fewer repetitive clarification tasks and more time for complex network issues.	PAINS Incomplete information. Manual tasks. Unstandardized requests. Human-error risk.	GAINS Automated task generation. Standardized process. Reduced human error. More time for complex issues.

6. Empathy Map — Approvers

Perspective: Managers or compliance officers responsible for approving network requests.

SAYS “I need enough information to approve this.” “Requests should follow policy.”	THINKS “Is this request appropriate and complete?” “Has the correct approval path been followed?”	DOES Reviews requests and provides approval or rejection decisions.
FEELS Wants quick, informed decisions with confidence in the process.	PAINS Manual routing. Incomplete context. Difficulty tracking pending approvals.	GAINS Structured approval routing. Policy enforcement. Better audit trails. Faster decision workflow.

7. Cross-Stakeholder Insight Map

Shared Need	Stakeholders Affected	ServiceNow Response	Expected Experience
Simple, structured request	Requesters + Fulfilment	Service Catalog + guided form	Less ambiguity
Complete information	Requesters + Fulfilment	Mandatory/conditional fields and validation	Fewer clarification cycles
Controlled decisions	Approvers + Admins	Approval routing + Flow Designer	Predictable governance
Less manual coordination	Admins + Fulfilment	Automated workflow and task creation	Lower repetitive workload
Status visibility	Requesters + all stakeholders	Request/task lifecycle tracking + notifications	Greater transparency
Traceability	Approvers + Admins	Records, approvals, roles and ACLs	Better auditability

8. Empathy-to-Solution Mapping

The empathy findings are translated into solution priorities so that each ServiceNow capability has a clear user or operational reason.

Empathy Insight	Design Response	ServiceNow Capability
Requester wants simplicity	Guided request experience	Service Catalog / Catalog Item
Requester wants visibility	Lifecycle status and notifications	Request/RITM tracking + Notifications
Approver wants informed decisions	Structured approval context	Approval routing / Flow Designer
Fulfilment wants complete data	Standardized request fields	Catalog variables + validation
IT Admin wants maintainability	Low-code orchestration	Flow Designer
Organization needs controlled access	Role separation and data protection	Roles + ACLs

9. Empathy Map Outcome

- Primary user experience priority: make network-service requests simple, guided, and visible.
- Operational priority: provide the Network Fulfilment Team with complete and standardized request information.
- Governance priority: give Approvers a structured decision path with traceability.
- Administration priority: use reliable, maintainable automation with minimal manual intervention.
- Overall design direction: connect the human needs of each stakeholder to a single ServiceNow request lifecycle.